

Week 1 – Live Session FAQ

1. What is Week 1 actually about in this programme?

Week 1 has two main goals:

- Give you a clear picture of where **Agentic AI** sits in the broader AI journey.
- Get you started with a **Python + ChatGPT** workflow you'll use throughout the programme.

In the live sessions, you will:

- Walk through the “Journey of AI” – traditional → generative → agentic.
- See where Agentic AI shows up in real use cases (support, operations, education, etc.).
- Run simple Python examples in notebooks, with ChatGPT helping you understand and debug them.

By the end of Week 1, you should know roughly what Agentic AI means and feel able to run and tweak small Python snippets with AI assistance.

2. What do you mean by “Agentic AI”, and how much of it will we really cover now?

In this week, Agentic AI is treated as a **high-level concept**, not something you build fully yet.

You will:

- See Agentic AI as systems that combine LLMs, tools/APIs, planning and some autonomy to work toward goals, not just answer one-off prompts.
- Compare traditional AI, generative AI and agentic systems with simple examples and diagrams.

You will **not** implement complex agents yet. Week 1 is about recognising the pieces and vocabulary so later weeks (which go deeper into planning, tools and agent workflows) make sense.

3. Do I need prior AI or machine learning knowledge to follow Week 1?

No formal AI or ML background is required.

Week 1 content uses:

- Plain-language explanations and diagrams.
- Focus on what these systems can/can't do and where they are useful.

You are **not** expected to know:

- Model training, neural networks, or transformers in detail.

What helps is being comfortable reasoning about inputs, outputs and what it means to automate a task. The technical depth ramps up later, after this conceptual foundation.

4. What level of Python should I already have, and is it okay if I'm new?

Python is **important** for this programme.

Ideally you can already:

- Read simple scripts with variables, lists, if statements, loops and basic functions.
- Run code and make sense of simple error messages.

If you're new:

- You can still follow Week 1, but you must be ready to invest time in practice, not just watch the demos.
- This is not a “no-code” course – agentic systems later assume basic comfort with Python.

The sooner you get comfortable reading and tweaking code, the easier the rest of the course will be.

5. I'm a beginner in Python. What do I need to do in Week 1 to avoid falling behind later?

Treat Week 1 as your **practice phase**, not just an orientation.

Aim to:

- Practise a bit **every day** (even 30–45 minutes):
 - Re-run the example notebooks.
 - Type code yourself, don't just copy–paste.
 - Change values and see how outputs change.

- Use ChatGPT actively:
 - Ask it to explain code and errors in simple terms.
 - Ask for a “simpler version” of any solution that feels too complex.

Like learning to ride a bike, balance comes from frequent short attempts, not one long session. If you use Week 1 this way, later agentic weeks will feel like natural extensions, not a leap.

6. Why are we learning Python and ChatGPT together instead of separately?

Because in realistic AI work, you **use them together** all the time.

Week 1 shows a simple loop:

- Describe a small task in natural language.
- Ask ChatGPT to draft or explain Python code.
- Run that code in a notebook and see what happens.
- Use ChatGPT again to interpret errors and refine the code.

This approach helps you:

- Learn Python faster, with explanations on demand.
 - Learn better prompting habits by seeing how clarity affects the code you get.
 - See ChatGPT as a strong assistant, not a replacement for understanding what your code does.
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7. Can I treat ChatGPT as a substitute for Python expertise in this programme?

No. ChatGPT **supports** your Python learning; it doesn't replace it.

In Week 1 you'll see that ChatGPT can:

- Over-complicate simple tasks.
- Invent functions or libraries that don't exist.
- Misread an error if it doesn't see enough of your code.

The programme expects you to:

- Use ChatGPT for ideas, explanations and debugging hints.
- Use your own Python understanding to check if the suggestion is sensible, simplify it, and test it.

You don't need to be an advanced programmer, but you do need enough Python comfort to trust your own judgement over a confident but wrong AI answer.

8. What exactly will we do with ChatGPT in the live sessions?

You'll use ChatGPT in **structured, practical ways**, such as:

- Prompting it to generate code for small tasks (like an EMI-style calculation or a basic to-do list).
- Asking it to explain existing code line by line.
- Sharing error tracebacks and asking for a diagnosis and minimal fix.
- Cleaning up code: better names, comments and simpler logic.

These patterns are demonstrated in the session and reinforced in the collaborative debugging/project activities.

9. What hands-on Python work will we actually do in Week 1?

You will work with **small but realistic** Python tasks, such as:

- Short scripts that perform simple calculations or list operations.
- Notebooks where you:
 - run and modify cells,
 - see how state is preserved,
 - inspect outputs and errors.
- A collaborative exercise where you run provided notebooks, use ChatGPT to fix bugs, and slightly improve the code.

The goal is to become comfortable running, reading and adjusting code, not to build large applications yet.

10. Will we set up Python, Jupyter or Google Colab together in class?

Yes, at a practical level.

In Week 1 you will:

- Walk through the basics of installing/checking Python.
- See how to:
 - open and run notebooks in Jupyter/JupyterLab,

- upload and run notebooks in Google Colab.

The live session will show you what a **working setup** looks like and the key steps. Very machine-specific issues may still need to be resolved using the written guides outside the session.

11. What kinds of debugging skills will we practise with ChatGPT?

Week 1 focuses on debugging situations you're likely to see early on:

- Syntax errors (missing colons, brackets, indentation).
- Type/value issues (mixing strings and numbers, invalid operations).
- Simple logic errors (wrong condition, incorrect formula, loops misbehaving).

You'll practise:

- Pasting the error and relevant code into ChatGPT.
- Asking for a clear explanation and minimal fix.
- Running the fixed code to verify that the explanation matches reality.

The aim is to make debugging a calm, repeatable process instead of guesswork.

12. What are the main pitfalls of using ChatGPT for coding that we will discuss?

Week 1 surfaces a few important pitfalls early so you can avoid them:

- **Over-engineering** – complex solutions for simple tasks.
- **Hallucinated APIs** – functions or libraries that don't exist where you're running code.
- **Misdiagnosed errors** – confident answers based on incomplete context.
- **Over-trusting the AI** – assuming "it runs" means "it's correct and maintainable".

You'll see how to:

- Ask for simpler versions of code.
 - Give better context in your prompts.
 - Rely on running and testing the code, not just reading the answer.
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13. How does Week 1 connect to the rest of the programme?

Week 1 is the **base layer** for both concepts and tools.

It gives you:

- A **conceptual map** of AI → generative AI → Agentic AI, so later frameworks and architectures aren't abstract.
- A **practical starting point**: Python installed, notebooks working, and a habit of using ChatGPT to read, write and debug code.

Later weeks assume this foundation, so the more solidly you treat Week 1, the easier it is to focus on agent behaviours, planning and tools later on.

14. Are we going to build production-ready applications or deploy code in Week 1?

No. Week 1 deliberately stays in a **learning environment**.

You will:

- Write and run small scripts and notebooks.
- Improve and debug them with ChatGPT's help.

You will **not** work on:

- deployment, packaging or infrastructure,
- security, performance or scaling.

Those belong to later design/engineering considerations. Right now, the focus is on getting you fluent with the basics you'll rely on when things get more agentic and complex.

15. What topics are clearly outside the scope of Week 1, even if they sound related to AI and agents?

To keep Week 1 focused, several topics are intentionally left for later:

- Training or fine-tuning models.
- Deep internals of transformers or attention mechanisms.
- Designing full multi-step or multi-agent workflows.
- Framework comparisons and advanced prompt engineering patterns.

Week 1 stays firmly on:

- understanding, at a high level, what Agentic AI is,
- getting comfortable with Python and notebooks,

- building a habit of using ChatGPT as a thoughtful coding and debugging partner.

Those basics are what everything else in the programme will lean on.